



# Ironworker

ironworker • 3 year apprenticeship

**\$55K-\$80K / yr**

## THE TRADE

Erect and reinforce the steel skeleton of buildings, bridges, and industrial structures. A physically demanding, outdoors-in-all-weather trade with top-tier pay — the 3-year union apprenticeship splits into structural, reinforcing, and ornamental divisions.

## SALARY & TRAINING

JOURNEYMAN BAND (SITE FIGURE — SAME AS QUIZ RESULT & TRADES PAGE)

**\$55K-\$80K**

Site band (trades page / quiz) • 3-yr apprenticeship (structural + reinforcing) • no dedicated salary post yet — assumed

## THE PATH: FROM RESEARCH TO HIRED

**01 RESEARCH** Compare training routes, union vs non-union, and local demand

**02 TRAIN** Trade school / pre-apprenticeship — start with OSHA 10

**03 HANDS-ON** Apprentice years: log hours, earn raises to 80-90% of scale

**04 CERTIFIED** Pass the journeyman or industry certification exam

**05 HIRED** Journey-level pay — specialize, stack certs, own the shop

Every apprentice track pays from day one — typical start is 40-50% of journey scale with scheduled raises every year. Each step above is fully mapped on the TradeLift Getting Started guide and the site's resources page.



# Ironworker — Roadmap, page 2

CERTIFICATIONS — FIRST 12 WEEKS

## REQUIRED CERTIFICATIONS & CREDENTIALS

OSHA 10 and OSHA 30 Hour (fall hazards front and center)

## YOUR FIRST 12 WEEKS — THE ACTION CHECKLIST

- ☐ Take the TradeLift quiz to confirm fit
- ☐ Earn OSHA 10 now (fall hazards covered)
- ☐ Get First Aid/CPR certified
- ☐ Draft a one-page trade resume
- ☐ Call the local Ironworkers' hall intake
- ☐ Search apprenticeship.gov ironworker roles
- ☐ Buy a spud wrench + safety glasses
- ☐ Practice climbing and tie-off drills
- ☐ Talk to a working rodman or journeyman
- ☐ Apply to the union apprenticeship
- ☐ Train for the physical agility test
- ☐ Get comfortable with heights early

Full career steps, certifications, and tool guides: <https://tradelift.surge.sh/getting-started.html>